

Z10

As soon as you pull out the device from the box, you will be struck by how aesthetically pleasing it is to the eye. In fact, many people have commented about how much the Z10 looks like the iPhone 5's cousin. Now, we're not suggesting that BlackBerry just sat down and copied the iPhone 5, or vice versa – instead we're saying that two good design teams, designing two flagship products, for pretty much a similar task-set and experience, might just have come up with something very similar. It's like F1 cars being designed in wind tunnels to offer maximum downforce, and also reduce drag at the same time. In the end, most F1 cars look identical to the untrained eye – not just because of the FIA's directives, but because there are only so many different paths a design team can take to improve performance.

The phone is almost all glass in the front and mostly plastic in the back. It's available in white and black in India, and we've heard rumours of more colours coming, but we cannot confirm that for sure. By far, our favourite colour hack was an experiment we saw on Crackberry.com that we also tried out for ourselves – putting the back panel of the black model on to the white phone to give you (in Crackberry's words) 'the BlackBerry Z10 Oreo'. No such phone exists, of course, but something tells us enough white Z10 users will go hunting for replacement black back panels. There's another reason for this, of course, not just aesthetics. The white Z10 back feels more plastic-like, whereas the black model has a softer, grippier, rubbery feel; as a result the black Z10 sits more securely in your palm, and inspires more confidence. If you own a white Z10, we suggest you try on the black back panel – you're sure to fall in love.

Q10

The Q10, on the other hand, screams BlackBerry with its traditional QWERTY keyboard. What most BlackBerry users will notice immediately, is that it's a hybrid touch-keyboard device, much like the BlackBerry Bold Touch 9900, but it's missing the optical scroll wheel/trackpad and the four soft-buttons that most older BlackBerry users swore by thus far – the menu, back, call and disconnect key are not on the Q10.

Here also, the white and black Q10s are slightly different. The white Q10 has a plastic back, while the black one comes with a back that's made using what BlackBerry call their 3D glass weave technology. Basically, instead of the plastic / glassy material being made in a cast, it's woven – and this gives it extra durability and flexibility, makes it tougher, and also makes each Q10